

of the project by a separate set of developers into a different direction/into a different final product). The core concept that unifies most open source development projects is the large amount of user participation. The open source development philosophy demands that users be considered as developers, with their feedback and cooperation made paramount in debugging and further development, while they are given a chance to rectify errors and add desired features themselves.

While some open source projects start off as standalone projects for applications with a fixed goal and a minimum reliable developer network such as Mozilla Firefox, other projects such as Linux distributions (namely Debian and Ubuntu) often start off without many fixed objectives. Their objectives, components and features often emerge as development proceeds, with the final product emerging as the sum total of the additions and the views of a lot of disparate developers.

While some projects do start off with a lone developer announcing his intentions to create a software for a certain purpose in a public medium and then being joined by other interested developers, the most successful ones are the ones that start off with a developer releasing a rudimentary codebase (a very simple version of the program finally intended, often lacking in convenience features and interfaces) to the public domain under an open source license, and then other developers joining the project.

Sometimes, open source projects are also created when the source code of a considerably well developed project is released to the public for further development, as happened with Netscape Navigator.

Some organisations dedicated to a project, such as the BSD operating systems, also use a more centralised approach to development, with a central storage location for all files, daily upgraded releases and a continuous updating system.

Thus with a large development base, the core features of the open source development methodology include rapid



The success of the Mozilla project has made it an inspirational rallying point for the open source community